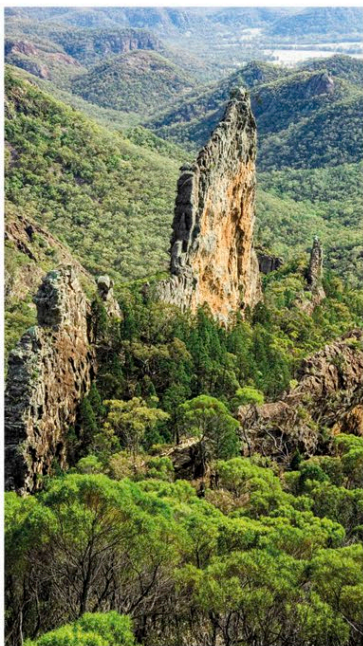




△ RAZOR SHARP

This rock pinnacle, known as the Breadknife, and similar outcrops in the Warrumbungles subrange are remnants of ancient volcanoes.

The Great Dividing Range

The main mountain range of Australia, stretching for more than 2,200 miles (3,500 km) down the country's eastern side



The third longest land-based mountain range in the world, the Great Dividing Range has many parts, including, for example, the Australian Alps in the south, the Blue Mountains and Warrumbungles in New South Wales, and the Clarke Range in Queensland. Its origins are complex and partly connected to the breakup of the ancient supercontinent of Gondwana that started more than 100 million years ago.

Diverse vistas

Landscapes across the range vary from hills covered with lush tropical rain forest in Queensland to snow-covered peaks farther

south. The mountains are the source of many of the country's major rivers, including the Murray–Darling (see p.282). The highest peak, Mount Kosciuszko (7,310 ft/2,228 m), is in the Australian Alps. The region's wildlife is as varied as its landscapes and includes kangaroos and platypuses. The area also boasts rich agricultural, timber, and mining resources.



◁ INDUSTRIAL TREASURE

The valuable metalloid element antimony, which has a variety of industrial uses, is mined at a few different sites in the Great Dividing Range.